

Chapter 4: English Communication

Class 17 – Reading Comprehension, Storytelling & Conversation Skills

Learning Objectives

After completing this lesson, students will be able to:

- Read short passages fluently with correct pronunciation.
 - Understand the meaning of a reading passage.
 - Answer comprehension questions accurately.
 - Develop storytelling skills using sequence and imagination.
 - Participate in simple conversations confidently.
 - Improve listening, speaking, and communication skills.
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Introduction

Reading helps us gain knowledge, improve vocabulary, and understand new ideas. Storytelling encourages creativity and confidence, while conversations help us express our thoughts clearly. By practicing reading, storytelling, and speaking, students become better communicators.

Reading Comprehension

Reading comprehension means reading a passage carefully and understanding its meaning.

Steps for Good Reading

- Read slowly and clearly.
 - Understand the meaning of new words.
 - Read the passage more than once if needed.
 - Identify the main idea.
 - Answer questions based on the passage.
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Reading Passage

The Helpful Tree

There was a large mango tree near a village school. Every day, children played under the tree during their lunch break. The tree gave them cool shade and sweet mangoes in summer. Birds built nests on its branches, and squirrels happily jumped from one branch to another.

One day, the children noticed that the tree needed water because the weather was very hot. They decided to bring water every morning and take care of it. Soon, the tree became healthy again. It continued to give shade, fruits, and a safe home for birds and animals. The children learned that caring for nature is everyone's responsibility.

Reading Comprehension Questions

Answer the following questions.

1. Where was the mango tree located?
2. What did the children do during lunch break?
3. Why did the children water the tree?
4. Who lived on the branches of the tree?
5. What lesson did the children learn?

Vocabulary from the Passage

Word	Meaning
Village	A small settlement
Shade	Protection from sunlight
Branch	Part of a tree
Healthy	Strong and free from illness
Responsibility	A duty or task

Storytelling

Storytelling means narrating a story in an interesting and organized way.

Steps for Storytelling

1. Begin with an introduction.
2. Introduce the characters.
3. Explain the events in order.
4. Describe the problem.
5. Tell how the problem was solved.
6. End with a moral or lesson.

Example Story

The Honest Woodcutter

A poor woodcutter accidentally dropped his axe into a river. He became very sad because it was his only tool. A fairy appeared and offered him a golden axe. The woodcutter honestly said it was not his. Then she showed him a silver axe, but he again said it was not his. Finally, she showed him his old iron axe. The woodcutter happily accepted it. The fairy rewarded his honesty by giving him all three axes.

Moral: Honesty is the best policy.

Picture-Based Storytelling

Students observe a picture and create a short story.

Suggested Picture Topics

- A rainy day
- A picnic in the park
- A school sports day
- A family picnic
- A visit to the zoo
- A birthday celebration

Story Guidelines

- Give the story a title.
 - Describe the picture.
 - Explain what happened.
 - End with a lesson or conclusion.
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Conversation Skills

Conversation is the exchange of ideas between two or more people.

Good Conversation Habits

- Listen carefully.
 - Speak politely.
 - Wait for your turn.
 - Maintain eye contact.
 - Answer in complete sentences.
 - Respect others' opinions.
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Sample Conversation

Topic: Favorite Hobby

Rahul: Good morning, Meena.

Meena: Good morning, Rahul.

Rahul: What is your favorite hobby?

Meena: My favorite hobby is reading storybooks.

Rahul: Why do you like reading?

Meena: It improves my knowledge and imagination.

Rahul: That's wonderful!

Expressing Opinions

Students learn simple expressions to share their ideas politely.

Examples

- I think...
 - In my opinion...
 - I like...
 - I agree because...
 - I do not agree because...
 - My favorite is...
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Listening Skills

Good communication begins with listening.

Listening Tips

- Listen without interrupting.
 - Focus on the speaker.
 - Think before answering.
 - Ask questions politely if something is unclear.
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Speaking with Confidence

Confidence Tips

- Speak clearly.
 - Use simple sentences.
 - Practice every day.
 - Smile while speaking.
 - Do not fear making mistakes.
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Classroom Speaking Activity

Students speak for **one minute** on any one topic.

Suggested Topics

- My Family
 - My School
 - My Best Friend
 - My Favorite Teacher
 - My Favorite Animal
 - My Favorite Festival
 - My Hobby
 - A Place I Visited
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Did You Know?

- Reading for just 15–20 minutes every day helps improve vocabulary and language skills.
 - Storytelling develops creativity and imagination.
 - Good listeners usually become good speakers.
 - Reading stories also improves memory and concentration.
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Points to Remember

- Read carefully and understand the passage.
- Learn the meanings of new words.
- Tell stories in the correct sequence.
- Speak politely and confidently.
- Listen carefully before replying.
- Practice reading aloud every day.